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City of Boulder Hiring Team

Planning & Development Services

RE: GIS, PLANNING & DEVELOPMENT SERVICES

Dear Hiring Team,

Good GIS work doesn't end with a map. It ends when someone can use the information to make a better decision. That has been the through-line of my GIS career—from building wildfire mapping tools for National Park Service staff to designing field-data workflows, maintaining geodatabases, and turning large, messy datasets into information that people can actually act on. I'd love to bring that combination of technical GIS skill and practical problem-solving to Boulder's Planning & Development Services team.

My GIS foundation goes back to my BA in Geography, with Honors, from Colgate University, where my thesis applied spatial statistics including kriging, IDW, and local Moran's I. I then spent three years with the National Park Service's Digital Maps team, building and maintaining geodatabases and web mapping applications in ArcGIS, Mapbox, and Carto. I developed wildfire-perimeter and endangered-species mapping tools for park staff who weren't GIS specialists, with an emphasis on data quality, documentation, and usability. That work ultimately contributed to NPS Park Tiles, the official basemap used across park websites.

I also bring experience that maps alone don't capture. At Fulcrum, I helped clients connect mobile field-data collection to enterprise GIS and asset-management workflows, working with tools including Survey123 and Fulcrum. At Teren, I worked with large geospatial datasets and machine-learning models built from drone and satellite imagery to assess environmental and infrastructure risk. And at Lytics, I worked extensively with SQL, BigQuery, Python, APIs, data validation, and data architecture to turn tens of millions of records into a reliable system others could use.

That broader technical experience is particularly relevant to this position. I enjoy the less glamorous parts of GIS that make the whole system work: cleaning data, troubleshooting, designing repeatable workflows, documenting standards, automating tedious processes, and sitting with the person who actually uses the data to understand what they need. My career has repeatedly put me in that translator role between technical systems and the people depending on them.

And this opportunity feels especially meaningful because it brings that work back to Boulder. GIS was the first professional language I learned, and Boulder is where I've chosen to build my life. The opportunity to apply my geospatial, data, and technical skills to the planning and development of the city I call home is a compelling combination.

I would be excited to contribute to P&DS—not simply by producing maps, but by building accurate, useful, well-documented spatial systems that help the people of Boulder do their jobs better.

Thank you for considering my application. I'd welcome the opportunity to talk.

Warmly,

Katrina Engelsted

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